

Statement of Interest

Wealth of Nations at 250 — Rapporteur Application

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Contributor preferences: (1) Besley & Ghatak (2) Rodrik (3) Voth

I am a PhD candidate in Economic History at the London School of Economics, funded by the ESRC. My dissertation examines sovereign debt and political institutions across the first age of globalisation, combining archival research with computational text analysis and panel econometrics.

My preferred assignments are Besley and Ghatak, Rodrik, and Voth, and the fit in each case is direct. My paper “Between Civilisation and Constitution: Greek Parliamentary Debates on Gold Standard Adoption, 1875–1885”, prepared for the Mary Morgan Retirement Workshop (June 2026), applies Morgan’s models as mediators framework to show how the gold standard operated in nineteenth-century Greek politics: not as a self-enforcing commitment mechanism but as a model whose authority depended on narrative embedding as much as technical demonstration. This puts me in close engagement with the questions Besley and Ghatak raise about the interplay between values, narrative, and economic institutions: their chapter on moral sentiments in market economies addresses exactly the mechanisms I reconstruct from the Greek parliamentary record. A companion paper on Greek legislative behaviour (1875–1905) uses 755 roll call votes to test whether fiscal shocks shift legislators from clientelist to programmatic behaviour, which is the question Besley and Ghatak address from the theoretical side: when do values and motivated agents reshape economic institutions rather than adapt to them?

Rodrik’s chapter raises the question of contextual versus universal application of economic ideas, which is the core of my paper’s misapplication claim: the critics of Greece’s gold standard adoption were technically correct, and they lost not because they were wrong but because they lacked a counter-model with comparable narrative authority. In Rodrik’s terms, the critics were making a proto-mercantilist case, prioritising contextual fit over universal principle, without a framework capable of matching the gold standard’s civilisational authority.

Voth’s chapter on conflict, colonialism, and the wealth of nations connects to my research on debt restructuring under the Ottoman Public Debt Administration, the Egyptian Caisse de la Dette, and the Greek International Financial Commission, where I study the fiscal infrastructure question from the borrower side using bond-level London Stock Exchange data. All three supervisory regimes followed military defeat and forced fiscal restructuring; my difference-in-differences estimates show significant yield spread convergence in each case, consistent with Voth’s argument that conflict-driven institutional change reshaped credit conditions for generations.

As a teaching assistant for EC311 (History of Economic Thought) at LSE, I regularly explain how economic ideas develop, travel, and are contested across time, which is the same task a rapporteur proceedings chapter performs for a conference contribution. I have presented my own research at WEHC (Lund, 2025) and the WEAI Annual Conference (San Francisco, 2025), and I write for audiences across economic history, political economy, and the history of economic thought.

Having active papers in each of the areas these chapters address, I would engage with the contributions as a researcher, not only as a note-taker. I attach my CV and a letter of support from my supervisor, Professor Albrecht Ritschl.

Education

- 09/2024– Present **MPhil/PhD Economic History**, *London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)*, London, UK
- Supervisors: Professors Albrecht Ritschl and Olivier Accominotti; Research focus: Political economy of late 19th-century Greek currency and debt
 - Selected for the ESRC-funded PhD Studentship, after turning down a place at Oxford University
 - Auditing modules in quantitative text analysis and applied deep learning for social science
- 09/2023 **Economics Summer School**, *University of Oxford*, Oxford, UK
- Completed "Foundations of Machine Learning" course by Prof. Maximilian Kasy; Studied PAC learning theory, regularisation, deep neural networks, and language models; Implemented algorithms in Python/scikit-learn
- 09/2022– 06/2024 **MSc Financial History**, *LSE*, London, UK
- Graduated with Distinction overall, having attended the programme part-time while working full-time
 - Modules in time series econometrics and history of global finance, requiring project work in R & Stata
 - Received a high distinction (82%) for my textual analysis dissertation, written in Python & R
- 09/2015– 06/2018 **BSc Economics**, *LSE*, London, UK
- Narrowly missed overall First Class honours, achieving 2:1 in final degree classification
 - Distinction in 6/12 modules, in fields such as economic history, macroeconomic principles and finance
- 09/2013– 06/2015 **IB Diploma (44/45)**, *St. Catherine's British (Embassy) School*, Athens, Greece
- Graduated tied 1st amongst my classmates & Top 1% worldwide

Teaching Experience

- 10/2024– Present **Teaching Assistant**, *LSE Economic History Department*, London, UK
- Teaching Assistant for EC311 (History of Economic Thought), EH390 (Stata Workshops), EC204 (History of Bubbles, Crashes and Inflation), EH101 and EH102 courses in economic and financial history
 - Graded assignments and held office hours with undergraduate students (including a summer school cohort)
 - Provided guidance and feedback from PhD students on research and teaching methodologies

Research Experience

- 01/2026– 04/2026 **Research Assistant**, *Professor Sir Rick Trainor (EHS Centenary Grant)*, LSE
- Primary researcher for Trainor's centenary paper "Whatever Happened to Social History? Social History in the Work of the Economic History Society, 1926–2026", presented at the EHS Centenary Conference (April 2026)
 - Reviewed and synthesised un-digitised EHS Council minutes, AGM reports, and committee records (1926–2010) at the LSE Library; negotiated access to restricted materials via LSE Reader Services and current EHS leadership
 - Classified 200+ articles from the *Economic History Review* and EHS conference programmes across 10 sample years (1927–2019) by topic and methodology to map century-long disciplinary trends
 - Drafted the conference abstract, presentation deck, and speaker notes delivered by Prof. Trainor at the EHS Centenary Conference
- 03/2026– 05/2026 **Research Assistant**, *Hellenic Observatory, LSE*, London, UK
- Supporting Laliotis & Minos (2025), "Economic Incentives and Vaccination"; building a corpus of Greek regional news coverage (summer 2021) and processing Cirium aviation arrivals data (April–August 2021) to measure the UK tourism demand shock at NUTS-3 level
- 11/2025– 07/2026 **Research Assistant**, *Prof. Almudena Sevilla & Dr. Dina Rabie*, LSE, Dept. of Social Policy
- Building Employment Tribunal dataset on discrimination in higher education institutions
 - Web scraping, data cleaning, and AI-assisted extraction (Gemini) of case details and outcomes
- 09/2023– 06/2024 **Research Assistant**, *Professor Albrecht Ritschl*, LSE
- Recalculated monetary aggregates in Germany during the Great Depression for a book in progress
 - Conducted archival research on practices to curb hyperinflation in Nazi-occupied Greece

Professional Experience

- 01/2024–06/2025 **Founder Associate, Operations**, *Genie (Seed-stage B2B SaaS, backed by NEA and GFC, in acquisition talks)*, London, UK
- AI-powered inventory management and purchase orders platform, available on Shopify
 - Fundraising: Prepared investor updates, constructed financial model, set up data room, conducted market research, built investor outreach lists, and drafted fundraising material for acquisition
 - Acted as HR lead, organising all-hands & offsite sessions, reviewing salaries and heading recruitment
 - Streamlined processes, particularly around customer support, onboarding, and data management
- 05/2021–07/2023 **Operations Manager**, *Clausematch (Regtech B2B SaaS, acquired by Corlytics in July 2023)*, London, UK
- Platform to collaborate on policy documents, backed by Index Ventures & Speedinvest
 - Liaised with investors in 2 funding rounds, while managing the data room and answering their DD requests
 - Responsible for company-wide and external reporting, including all-hands, investor update & board deck
 - Acted as an HR Manager for a scaling organisation of 70+ people, coordinating recruitment & onboarding
- 08/2020–12/2020 **Visiting Analyst, Investment Team**, *Creandum (Early-stage VC with pan-European presence)*, Stockholm, Sweden
- Stellar record in early product-driven investments like Spotify, Trade Republic, Kry & Vivino
 - Undertook due diligence, interviewing customers and conducting market analysis for deals, such as: Series A round for SafetyWing (health benefits for the remote workforce); Pre-Seed for lemon.markets (trading equities through an API)
 - Proactively established relationships with CEE investors and generated leads in the same geography
- 03/2020–07/2020 **Visiting Analyst, Chief Investment Office**, *Speedinvest (Seed-stage VC, one of Europe's most active, managing €1B+)*, Vienna, Austria
- Investments globally across multiple funds
 - Owned fund model design for the General Partner (GP): allocation optimisation and scenario analysis
 - Drafted answers to FAQs from sophisticated institutional LPs in the DD stage, such as the EIF
 - Conducted an internal study, sourced from the portfolio, on startup board composition and its importance
- 06/2019–12/2019 **Intern, Finance Team**, *N26 (Neobank, raised \$300M Series D from Insight and GIC)*, Berlin, Germany
- Mobile app, that is a regulated digital bank with 7M+ customers in 25 markets
 - Provided detailed updates to the Board on the Group's performance, sourcing and modelling data
 - Constructed bottom-up business cases (revenue modelling) for new and existing products
- 09/2018–02/2019 **Off-Cycle Analyst, FIG Banking**, *Morgan Stanley (Multinational investment bank, leading position in tech advisory)*, London, UK
- Globally recognised for its Financial Institutions Group (FIG), an industry team within IBD
 - Prepared discussion materials for C-level client meetings & board presentations (such as NBS)
 - For live processes (acquisitions), managed logistics between parties and answered vendor requests

Academic Positions

- 01/2026–Present **Inaugural DTP Student Representative**, *LSE ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership*, London, UK
- Appointed to inaugural student representation role within the LSE ESRC DTP, selected for dual perspective as LSESU PGR Officer and ESRC-funded doctoral researcher
 - Attend termly DTP Management Committee meetings; developing approaches to gathering and responding to student perspectives within DTP governance
- 10/2025–Present **GTA Officer**, *LSESU*, London, UK
- Representing Graduate Teaching Assistants in university governance; attending senior LSE committees including the Research Degrees Sub-committee (RDSC), Research Students' Consultative Forum, and Academic Board
 - Working with UCU on campus advocacy; leading UKRI stipend campaign with other unions; coordinating GTA contract mapping across 25 LSE departments
- 10/2025–Present **Writing Advisor**, *LSE Economic History Department*, London, UK
- Providing writing advice sessions to undergraduate students
 - Monitoring student welfare alongside academic support
- 09/2025–Present **LSE Graduate Economic History Seminar**, *LSE*, London, UK
- Co-convenor of weekly PhD seminar series (Autumn 2025), managing applications and program organization
 - Outreach to international academic networks and manage seminar logistics for diverse participant pool

Academic Affiliations

- 12/2024–Present **PhD Affiliate**, *Data Science Institute, LSE*, London, UK
- Part of an inter-disciplinary network that holds research seminars and workshops on machine learning applications

- 12/2024– **Doctoral Affiliate, Hellenic Observatory, LSE, London, UK**
Present
 - One of two doctoral candidates selected for the inaugural 2024/25 pilot scheme
 - Allocated a mentor from senior members and research budget for conferences and fieldwork

Awards

- 09/2024– **ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership (DTP) Award, LSE, London, UK**
06/2028
 - Selected for prestigious fully-funded studentship covering tuition fees and maintenance stipend

12/2024 **Runner-up, MSc Financial History Dissertation Prize, LSE, London, UK**
 - Highly recommended for the MSc Financial History Dissertation Prize
 - Dissertation eligible for publication in the LSE Economic History student working paper series

05/2015 **Winner, Generation €uro Students' Award, European Central Bank (ECB), Frankfurt, Germany**
 - Awarded first place in a Euro-wide team competition on monetary policy, received prize from Mario Draghi
 - Led a group of 5 students that predicted the ECB's decision during tense Greek government negotiations

Skills

- Languages Greek (Native), English (Native), German (studying for B2)
Technical Python, R, Stata, SQL, JavaScript; pandas, scikit-learn, tidyverse; Excel

Research Interests

Core Themes

Sovereign Debt; Financial Markets; Political Institutions; First Age of Globalisation; Text-as-Data; LLMs; History of Economic Thought

Working Papers

- “Made in Greece or Echoed from Europe? Sentiment and Awareness Among International Partners During the 1931–1932 Greek Sovereign Debt Crisis” (draft). Employs a novel LLM-based text-as-data approach on the Tsouderos Archive (private correspondence of the Bank of Greece Governor) to map sentiment and topic trends in communications with foreign officials. Identifies two structural breaks (June and September 1931) via change point analysis; SVAR shows significant negative correlation between archive sentiment and Greek bond yields.
- “From War Finance to Fiscal Supervision: Seniority Structures and Debt Restructuring in the Ottoman Empire, Egypt, and Greece, 1870–1907” (draft). First comparative empirical analysis of supervisory regimes (OPDA, Caisse de la Dette, IFC) using bond-level London Stock Exchange data. DiD estimates: -1.39 pp (Ottoman), -0.42 pp (Egypt), -0.36 pp (Greece), all $p < 0.001$. Greek case shows yield spread inversion ($p = 0.035$) driven by state-contingent coupons; proposes minimal extension to Ho–Ritschl (2024) seniority reversal model.
- “Permeable Patronage: Fiscal Crises and Domain-Specific Defection in the Greek Parliament, 1875–1905” (draft). Tests whether fiscal shocks produce programmatic legislative transitions using 755 nominal roll call votes (132,246 MP–vote observations, 1,049 MPs) linked to a biographical registry and classified by policy domain across eight political shocks. After the 1893 default, Peloponnesian MPs defect 7.3 pp more on taxation ($p = 0.006$) but not on non-fiscal votes. Adapts Krehbiel’s identification problem to clientelist legislatures via π -pattern/ π -binding decomposition.
- “Between Civilisation and Constitution: Greek Parliamentary Debates on Gold Standard Adoption, 1875–1885” (draft, prepared for Mary Morgan Retirement Workshop, June 2026). Reconstructs parliamentary debates using newly digitised Hellenic Parliament proceedings. Argues the gold standard operated as a “model” (Morgan’s sense) whose authority depended on narrative embedding; the central claim is *misapplication* rather than wrong theory. Maps eleven parliamentarians across constitutional, distributional, regional, and technical registers; analyses absence of bimetallism as counter-narrative.

Work in Progress

- “Sterling by Design: Contractual Standardisation and Currency Dominance on the London Stock Exchange, 1869–1929”. Security-level panel of 957 sovereign debt instruments (IMM). Sterling’s share of income flows rose from 79% to 99% as multi-currency clauses, bullion clauses, and non-sterling denominations were eliminated. Bai–Perron breaks in late 1870s–1880s precede periphery gold adoption; captive borrowers paid 0.90 pp yield premium over outside-option borrowers.
- “Why Did Depositors Run? Withdrawals in the German Banking Crisis of 1931” (with Philip Fliers, Queen’s University Belfast). Bimonthly bank-level balance sheets (1925–1935). Severe withdrawals were widespread, highly predictable up to two years prior, and differed systematically across maturities. Withdrawals accompanied by substantial deposit reallocation across banks.

Academic Activity

Conferences

- WEHC (Lund, Sweden, 07/2025): Poster Presentation
- WEAI 100th Annual Conference (San Francisco, CA, 06/2025): Paper Presentation

Workshops

- SMGS Graduate Research Colloquium (Reading, UK, 05/2025): Paper Presentation
- YSI-EHES Economic History Graduate Webinar Series (Virtual, 05/2025): Paper Presentation

Seminars

- Hellenic Observatory Research Seminar (LSE, 12/2025): Paper Presentation
- DSI PhD Affiliate Lightning Talks (LSE, 02/2025): Presentation
- DSI PhD Affiliate Research Spotlight (LSE, 11/2025): Paper Presentation

[To be printed on LSE letterhead and signed by Professor Albrecht Ritschl]

[Date]

Dear Organising Committee,

I am writing to support the application of Aristeidis Grivokostopoulos for the rapporteur position at the Wealth of Nations at 250 conference at Glasgow.

Aristeidis joined the LSE Economic History PhD programme in September 2024, funded by an ESRC DTP studentship. He is a second-year PhD student with four working papers in circulation, conference presentations at WEHC (Lund, 2025) and the WEAI Annual Conference (San Francisco, 2025), and affiliations with the LSE Data Science Institute and the Hellenic Observatory.

His research is directly relevant to all three of his preferred assignments. His paper “Between Civilisation and Constitution: Greek Parliamentary Debates on Gold Standard Adoption, 1875–1885”, prepared for the Mary Morgan Retirement Workshop (June 2026), applies Morgan’s models as mediators framework to show how economic ideas fail when applied without their preconditions, connecting directly to the questions Besley and Ghatak raise about values and institutions and to Rodrik’s argument about contextual versus universal policy. A companion paper uses 755 roll call votes to test whether fiscal shocks shift legislators from clientelist to programmatic behaviour, extending that institutional analysis to the legislative level. His work on debt restructuring in the Ottoman Empire, Egypt, and Greece uses bond-level London Stock Exchange data to estimate the credit market effects of conflict-driven fiscal supervision, with difference-in-differences estimates showing significant yield spread convergence in all three cases. This connects his empirical work directly to the fiscal infrastructure questions at the heart of Voth’s chapter. He combines archival research with computational text analysis, writes well for audiences across economic history and the history of economic thought, and teaches EC311 (History of Economic Thought) at LSE.

I am happy to support his application.

Yours sincerely,

Professor Albrecht Ritschl
Department of Economic History
London School of Economics and Political Science